



The Level 3 course builds the foundations students need to become independent problem solvers in language arts. Over the course of the year, students explore ancient Greece while developing targeted reading, writing, critical thinking, and grammar skills. The course is divided into four project-based quarters. All of the projects, readings, and activities in the class are designed to foster reading, writing, critical thinking, and public speaking skills at a level that is appropriately challenging.

The goal of AoPS Academy Language Arts courses is to train the intellectual leaders of the next generation by fostering creative problem solving. In our classes, students tackle projects that are framed as interpretation and communication problems: how can we communicate an idea in just the right way? Or, how can we understand complex ideas that are being communicated to us? To solve these problems, students must craft written pieces and oral presentations that demonstrate mastery of the Language Arts skills they learned in class. In this way, our courses help students develop the confidence and advanced literacy skills they need to solve any communication problem they encounter, whether it's in college, in the professional world, or in their own lives.

Time Commitment: This 36-week course includes 105 minutes of in-class instruction and 60-90 minutes of homework each week, corresponding to a full-year course.

Homework: Students should expect to spend about 1–2 hours on homework every week. Homework will include practicing the reading, writing, and grammar skills covered in class, working on ongoing writing projects, and completing reading assignments. Students are expected to read independently throughout the year from assigned novels and nonfiction books. Students will take weekly reading quizzes on the course homepage to ensure that they are keeping up with the reading.

Content:

Week	Topic	Week	Topic
1	Athena's Challenge: Intro to Myth	19	Dionysus' Challenge: Scriptwriting
2	Characterizing with Nouns	20	Build: Narrative Elements
3	Myth: The Takeaway	21	Plan: Introducing SWBST
4	Myth: Supernatural Elements	22	Drive: Revealing Character
5	Make your myth!	23	Drive: Advancing the Plot
6	Revision: Using Pronouns	24	Revision: Using Modifiers
7	Revision: Abstract Nouns	25	Revision: Script Formatting
8	Writer's Workshop	26	Writer's Workshop
9	Myth Presentations and Exam 1	27	Play Performances and Exam 3
10	Plato's Challenge: Philosophical Thinking	28	Homer's Challenge: Research
11	Supporting with Reasons	29	Organizing Your Findings
12	Organizing Your Reasons	30	Descriptive Writing
13	Outlining Your Testimony	31	Creative Linking
14	Drafting Your Testimony	32	Procedural Language
15	Revision: Complete Sentences	33	Revision: If/Then Statements
16	Revision: Connecting Words	34	Revision: Possessives
17	Writer's Workshop	35	Writer's Workshop
18	Trial Testimony and Exam 2	36	Prototyping and Exam 4

The course is divided into four project-based units:

Unit	Description	Common Core Standards	Core Skills or Concepts
1 Storytelling & Mythology	Students explore myths while creating their own, applying the craft of narrative to myth-writing. They present their myth at the close of the unit. Book: <i>Gifts From the Gods</i>	• RL 3.1, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.7 • RI 3.4A-C • W 3.3A-D, 3.4-6, 3.10 • SL 3.1A, 3.1B, 3.2, 3.4 • L 3.1A, 3.1C, 3.1H, 3.1I, 3.2F, 3.3A, 3.3B, 3.5A, 3.6, 3.4.C	• characterization and story structures • uses and implementation of literary devices (e.g. symbolism, epithet) • parts of speech • concrete and abstract nouns • personal pronouns • complete sentences
2 Crafting an Argument	Students explore a philosopher's trial in Athens and produce persuasive essays. They argue their point of view at the close of the unit. Book: <i>What's the Point of Philosophy</i>	• RL 3.1, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.5, 3.6, 3.7 • RI 3.1-3.3 • RF 3.4A-C • W 3.1A-D, 3.2B, 3.2C, 3.2D, 3.4-5, 3.10 • SL 3.1A, 3.2, 3.4, 3.6 • L 3.1A, 3.1.I, 3.3A, 3.3B, 3.5, 3.6	• using reference materials • supplying informed reasons to support an opinion • crafting introductions & theses • making inferences and arguments • forming editorial "spin" and rhetorical strategies • creating an original persuasive essay for a target audience
3 Theatrical Storytelling	Students are introduced to scriptwriting through staging their own original play over the course of the unit. Book: <i>How to Stage a Catastrophe</i>	• RL 3.1, 3.3, 3.5, 3.7, 3.9, 3.10 • RI 3.4A, 3.4B • W 3.3A-D, 3.4-6, 3.10 • SL 3.1A, 3.1B, 3.2, 3.3 • L 3.1A, 3.2A, 3.2C, 3.3A, 3.5A-B, 3.6	• telling a complete story in script • revealing character and advancing plot • literal and figurative uses of language • adding description with modifiers • creating and capitalizing titles • bringing characters to life in a script
4 Research and Procedural Writing	Students research monsters from world mythologies to create a new monster, learning informational and procedural writing. Students test their writing in a final simulation. Book: <i>Tales from The Odyssey, Part 1</i>	• RL 3.1-5, 3.7 • RI 3.1-5, 7-10 RF 3.3A-D, 3.4A-C • W 3.1A, 3.1B, 3.1C, 3.1D, 3.4, 3.5, 3.6, 3.10 • SL 3.1A-D, 3.2, 3.3, 3.4, 3.6 • L 3.1.A, 3.1H, 3.1I, 3.2.D, 3.4A-C	• sorting findings from articles • crafting procedural text • distinguishing subordinate and main clauses • using transitions and subordinators • incorporating singular and plural possessives • evaluating procedural and informational writing

To interpret the Common Core Standards column on the table above, visit the Common Core ELA website at www.thecorestandards.org/ELA-Literacy/